



Wait a minute, who ARE you?

A 15 year old Nagpur boy won a coding contest which led to him getting a job offer in the USA!
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versatile companion apps we've ever used with TWS earbuds. The app has nifty features such as a 5-band customisable EQ, sound presets, charging status, and customisable controls. Aside from that, the earbud's app allows users to access features such as Adaptive Sound Control, DSEE Extreme, Earbud Fit test, and more.

Adaptive Sound Control is a useful feature that uses AI smarts to determine your activity (staying, walking, running, or transport) and applies noise-cancellation settings accordingly. DSEE Extreme is a feature that uses AI to upscale compressed lossy files. The Earbud Fit test is convenient and it lets you know if the ear tips you've used are giving you a good seal.

One of our favourite features of the Sony WF-1000XM4 is the Quick Attention mode feature. Simply pressing and holding the left earbud will activate Ambient Sound and turn down the media volume so you can have a quick conversation without having to pause your music. The earbuds are IPX4 water resistant and support Google's Fast Pair and Microsoft's Swift Pair as well.

The AirPods Pro is no slouch when it comes to features as well, but most of these are exclusive to users with Apple devices only, which is a huge limitation. The settings screen allows users to access features such as an Ear Tip Fit Test, and Spatial Audio with Head Tracking. The ear tip fit test allows you to find the best ear tips for your ears, like on the Sony Mark 4. The spatial audio feature is something we've already raved about above.

One feature the AirPods sport that the Sonys don't is handsfree assistant support, in this case, handsfree Siri. Simply saying 'Hey Siri' will invoke the voice assistant who you can give commands to for various actions. It's an extremely nifty feature that takes out the physical element of having to manually trigger assistant every time you need to use it.

Despite this, the Sony WF-1000XM4 takes home the Features crown since not only does it have

a considerably larger feature set in comparison to the AirPods Pro but it also isn't platform exclusive. So, you can use most of the Mark 4s features on an iPhone as well by downloading the Headphones Connect app.

Features winner - Sony WF-1000XM4

BATTERY LIFE

On the face of it, both the AirPods Pro and the Sony WF-1000XM4 seem to have similar battery life with



24 hours of total playback time provided with the earbuds and charging case. What makes all the difference in Sony's case is that it lasts a whopping 8 hours on a single charge (ANC turned on), while the AirPods Pro only lasts 5 hours on a single charge (ANC turned on). So, you will need to juice up the Sony Mark 4s far lesser than AirPods Pros, which is a crucial advantage. Additionally, with ANC turned off, the Sony WF-1000XM4 can provide 32 hours of battery life. In our tests, the Sony WF-1000XM4 lasted 7 hours and 52 minutes with ANC turned on while the AirPods Pro lasted 4 hours and 42 minutes with ANC on.

Both earbuds also come with fast charging support. Charge the Sony for just five minutes and you'll get an hour's worth of usage and charging the AirPods Pro for 10 minutes provides the same playback time, so the Sonys win here. Both earbuds also support Qi wireless charging for the case, which is convenient, but slower than wired charging.

Battery life winner - Sony WF-1000XM4

VALUE

The Sony WF-1000XM4 is priced at Rs 19,990 in India while the AirPods Pro, which launched at Rs 24,990, can now be purchased for around 20.5 - 21K on e-commerce sites. The price difference between the two is negligible enough at this point but not at the time of launch. Both also have a vast feature set and excellent performance to justify the asking price. While we would

have given the win to the Sony WF-1000XM4 for value at launch, as it stands today, it ends up being a tie.

Value winner - Tie

VERDICT

So, there you have it! It was an incredibly close race, with the Sony WF-1000XM4 scrapping ahead with the win by earning 5 points as compared to the AirPods Pro's 4 points. While the Sony WF-1000XM4 doesn't quite run circles around the AirPods Pro, it does beat them in key areas such as sound quality, active noise cancellation, and battery life - all of which are integral to a user's end experience. Sony also makes its feature set more accessible to the masses via the Headphones Connect app, something that the AirPods Pro lack. Nevertheless, if you are embedded into the Apple ecosystem, we'd still ask you to cast away the extra points Sony got and go for the AirPods Pro regardless due to the seamless connectivity, integration with Apple devices, and unique feature set. **1**